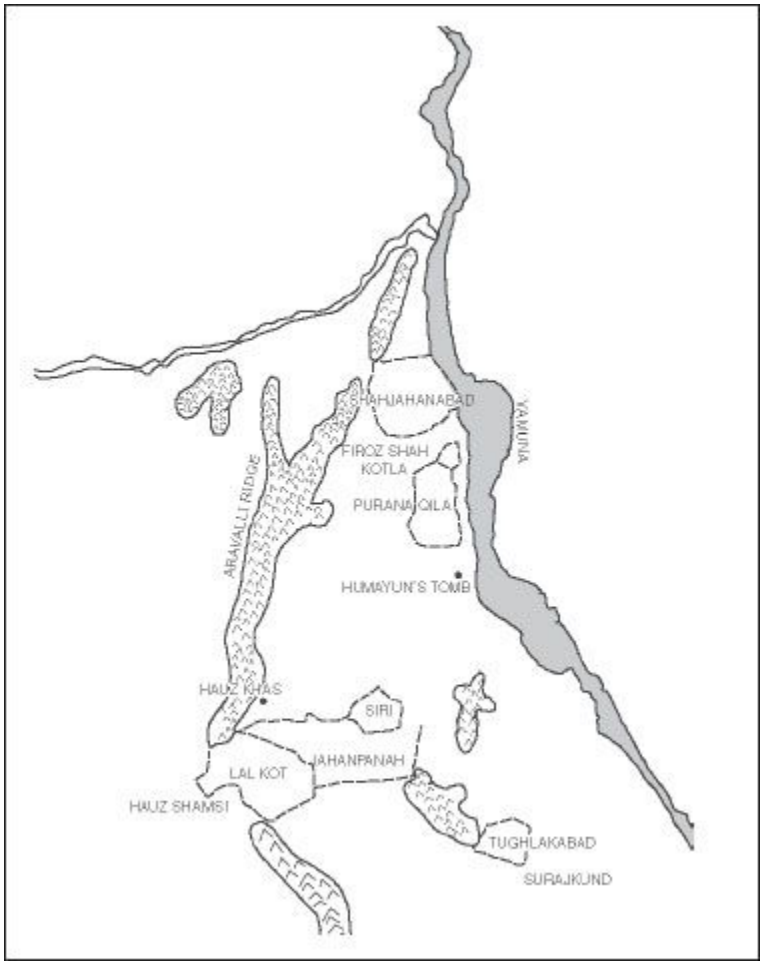

Medieval Delhi

Sadly for Delhi, Akbar shifted the capital south to Agra and then to a newly built city called Fatehpur Sikri. The latter took fifteen years to build but it was abandoned after only fourteen years because, like Tughlaqabad, its water supply was deemed unreliable. The capital moved back to Agra. Meanwhile, Delhi remained an important city but would have to play second fiddle to Agra till Akbar's grandson built Shahjehanabad (Old Delhi) a century later. Akbar did, however, make one important addition to Delhi's skyline—the tomb of his father. Humayun's tomb is a grand affair and an architectural precursor to the Taj Mahal. Since it is not usually mobbed by tourists like the Taj, it is a much more satisfying place to linger and retains the air of an emperor's tomb.